

# When a video production company is ready for a coach

The right time to hire a video business coach is when the business already pays you, the same problem keeps coming back, and you can say in your own words what another year of it will cost. Revenue matters less than most owners think: the VBA Elite Boardroom states around \$150K a year as the baseline, not the test. Before that point, the fundamentals are better learned from free material.

## What are the signs a production company is ready for a coach?

The signs a production company is ready for a coach are about how the business runs and what it's costing you, not how big it is.

- **Everything runs through you.** Delivery, decisions and income depend on you personally. If you stop, everything stops, and the growth plan is more of your own hours.
- **Busy, but not secure.** Work is coming in, yet growth depends on you saying yes to almost everything, and each new job adds complexity rather than stability.
- **You're the highest-paid project manager in your own business.** There's a team and some systems, revenue is predictable, and you can take a week off but not a month.
- **The same problem keeps coming back.** You've done the courses and the downloads and it's still there, which usually means it was never an information problem.
- **You can say what standing still costs.** Burnout if you keep working the way you do now, a long client relationship under strain, no margin figures on your own books: a specific cost, in your words, with a date attached.

## How do you test your own readiness for coaching?

Test your readiness for coaching by writing down, in your own words, what another twelve months of the current way will cost you, and what you'll put in to change it.

### Copy and paste: the readiness check

If nothing changes in the next 12 months, the cost to me is: [hours, money, health, family, a client at risk].

It has to be different by: [date].

The problem that keeps coming back is: [one sentence].

The last thing I changed because of advice I was given: [one thing].

Hours a week I'll give to work on the business, not in it: [hours].

When I'm in delivery, I'm reachable: [yes, or how often].

When someone challenges how I run the business, I usually: [listen, argue, go quiet].

Read it back. A specific cost with a date, one thing you've already acted on, and time set aside describe an owner ready for coaching. "Things are fine, I'd just like more" doesn't: when nothing is at stake, the work gets done when it's interesting and dropped when it isn't.

## What does too early look like?

Too early looks like a business still working out how to get steady work in the door.

At that stage the job is focus: one clear offer, one defined type of client, one repeatable way work comes in, and a minimum project fee you hold without exceptions. Free material covers those well. Start with [how to price a video project](#) and [how to qualify a video lead before you pitch](#), then the rest of the [Field Guides](#).

## Does revenue decide whether you are ready for coaching?

Revenue doesn't decide readiness for coaching on its own: it tells a coach you can pay, which is the smallest question.

The VBA Elite Boardroom states around \$150K a year as the baseline, and that's the baseline, not the test. Below it, cash is usually the constraint and free material does more. Above it, readiness shows in behaviour: doing the work between calls, acting within days rather than weeks, and taking a challenge without needing to win the argument. A large turnover and an impressive client list don't make an owner ready, and they make it easier to skip the question of whether anything is at stake.

## When should you wait, even past the baseline?

Wait, even past the baseline, if you can't give the work time between sessions over the next few months, or if what you want is agreement rather than direction.

- **A delivery season that takes you offline for weeks.** Not a reason to wait indefinitely, but raise it before you join and plan the coaching around the weeks you're available.
- **Shopping for agreement.** If you want a coach to confirm a decision you've already made, you'll be paying for agreement and the decision won't get tested.
- **Looking for the smarter route.** If what you're avoiding is the direct work, the price you haven't sent or the call you haven't made, coaching will point straight back at it.

## Who the VBA Elite Boardroom is for, and who it isn't for

The VBA Elite Boardroom is for established production company owners who are done being the only person everything routes through, and it isn't for owners still finding steady work or anyone who wants to attend calls without doing the work between them.

It's \$1,700 USD a month, flat, with no onboarding fee, no application, no minimum term and no refunds. Month one is the fit test, and it runs both ways. If that reads like you, start with [how the coaching works](#).

**Related tools and guides.** What a video business coach actually does, How to choose a coach for your video production company, Questions to ask a video business coach before you hire them, Why knowing your numbers lets you price with confidence, When one big client owns your video business.



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The field guides show you how the system works. The Boardroom is where I look at your business with you, give you perspective and judgement on what to do next, and hold you to it every week.

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